

Richard Xiong

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EDUCATION

Virginia Polytechnic Institute and State University

Blacksburg, VA

Major: FinTech and Big Data Analytics - Minor: Computer Science, Mathematics | GPA: 3.85

Expected graduation Spring 2028

- Relevant Coursework: Linear Algebra, Multivariable Calculus, Data Structures and Algorithms, Probability and Distributions, Statistical Methods and Modeling, Financial Modeling

WORK EXPERIENCE

Process Automation and AI Intern

Arlington, VA

Blake Wilson Group

Jun 2025 - Aug 2025

- Designed and deployed 7 custom Power Apps solutions integrated with Power Automate to streamline internal workflows across document management, Accounts Payable, and data entry, reducing manual processing time by 20% and impacting 10+ employees daily.
- Contributed to a Python tool using OpenAI's Assistants API with file search to retrieve context from a SharePoint-based proposal archive, generating draft proposal sections that incorporated relevant historical content and reduced manual drafting time.
- Developed an OCR-based document processing automation that eliminated manual data extraction, reducing associated manual work by 40% and improving data accuracy across key business processes such as payroll.
- Built and maintained SharePoint-integrated data pipelines to centralize document storage and retrieval, improving cross-departmental access and reducing time spent searching for records.
- Presented a company-wide Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning lesson to 30 executives and employees, educating staff on basic AI terminology, industry trends, and fostering innovation across the company.
- Researched and evaluated AI and automation platforms specific to government firms to support tooling decisions, delivering a comparative analysis of solutions that informed leadership's technology roadmap.

PROJECTS & LEADERSHIP

Undergraduate Research Assistant

Blacksburg, VA

Virginia Tech FinTech Club

Oct 2025 - Present

- Fine-tuned GPT-4o-mini via OpenAI's fine-tuning API on the Financial PhraseBank allagree subset (Hugging Face), building a Python pipeline to convert raw text into JSONL training format; fine-tuned model outperformed the base model on a held-out test set across precision, recall, and F1.
- Applied the fine-tuned model to score SAFE clauses across multiple sentiment dimensions (risk, business overview, financial health), reducing run-to-run score variance from $\sim \pm 30$ to $\sim \pm 10$ on a 0-100 scale by mitigating compounding non-determinism in the multi-step lexicon-matching and rubric-scoring pipeline.
- Web-scraped and parsed 1000+ SEC EDGAR filings in Python to build the SAFE corpus, structuring extracted clauses into a labeled inventory for sentiment scoring and trend analysis.
- Synthesizing findings from 20+ academic papers and industry reports on SAFE adoption versus traditional equity rounds and convertible notes, contributing to a faculty-led research paper on early-stage startup financing.

Professional Development Director

Blacksburg, VA

Phi Gamma Nu - Professional Entrepreneurship Fraternity

Apr 2026 - Present

- Elected Professional Development Director for a 50+ member chapter of a national professional business fraternity; oversee speaker events, corporate visits, and skill workshops for the fall 2026 term
- Coordinating semester programming, including 5 industry speaker events and technical workshops covering resume review, storytelling prep, and AI usage in Finance.

Stock Screener Project

Blacksburg, VA

Passion Project

Sep 2025 - Present

- Built a Python tool that pulls 1 year of historical daily price data from yfinance and computes technical indicators (20- and 50-day simple moving averages, 14-period RSI) using pandas rolling-window operations.
- Designed a two-pane Matplotlib visualization with an interactive ticker-input widget for switching symbols on the fly, including RSI threshold bands at 30 and 70 to mark oversold and overbought regions.
- Implemented input validation and error handling for empty responses and invalid tickers, displaying inline error states without crashing the visualization.

Capital One Tech Summit

Virtual

Capital One

Jan 2026

- Hand-selected by a Capital One recruiter for a week-long fintech program featuring technical workshops and a hackathon focused on banking solutions for current and future generations.
- Led team coordination on a hackathon project building tools for first-generation students' financial decisions, owning user research, competitor analysis, and content curation for the product database.

SKILLS SUMMARY

- **Security Clearance:** Current Public Trust
- **Programming Languages:** Java, Python, C, R, x86_64 Assembly
- **Libraries & Frameworks:** Pandas, NumPy, Matplotlib, yFinance, JUnit, OpenAI API
- **Tools & Platforms:** Docker, Git, Linux, Power Automate, Excel, web scraping
- **Quantitative Methods:** Statistical modeling, regression analysis, data visualization
- **Interests:** Foodie, Poker, Table Tennis, Sudoku, Billiards, Financial Markets, Macroeconomics